

Qiskit Global Summer School 2026

A Decade on the Cloud



Attendee Guide

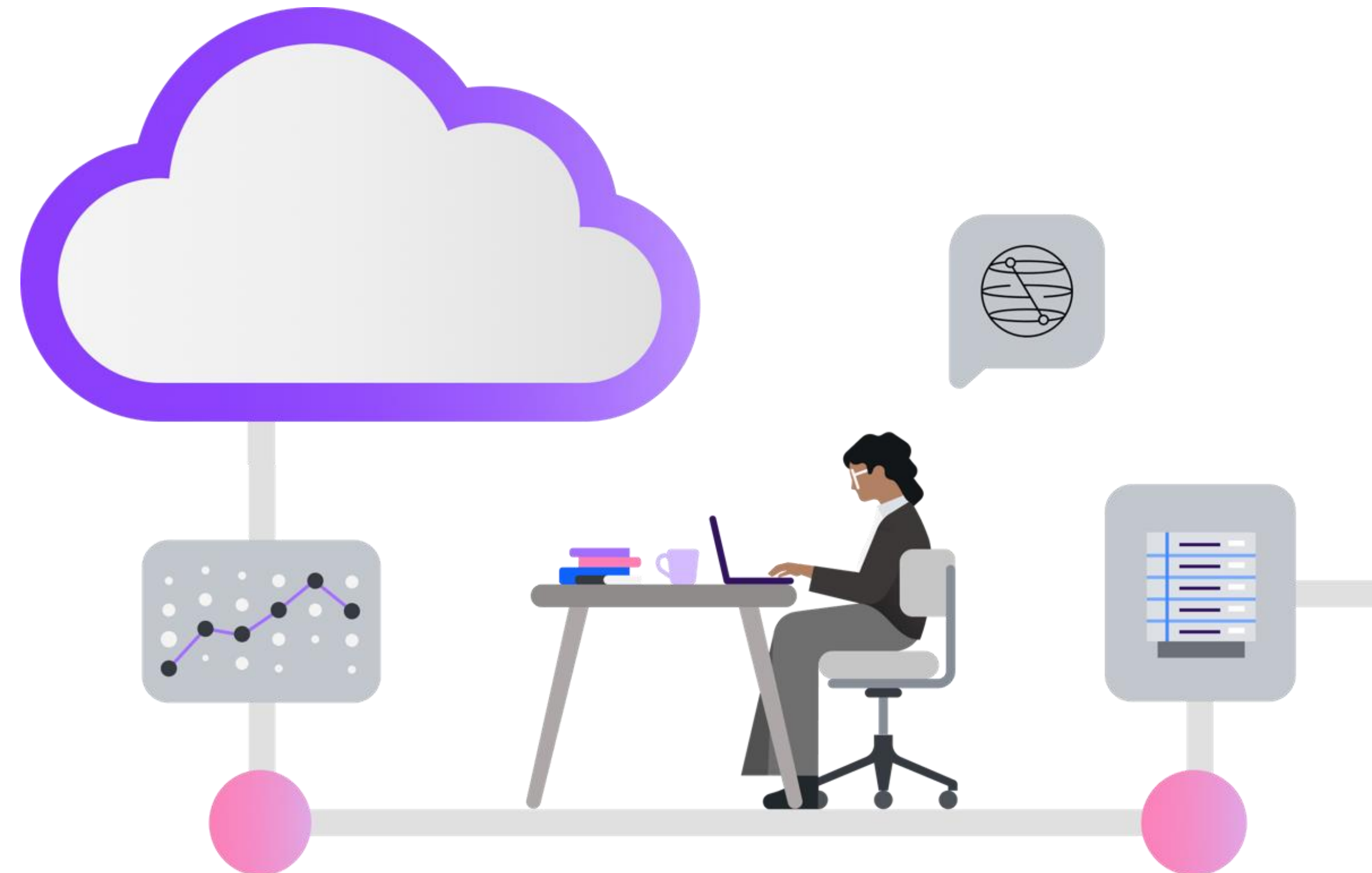


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About The Summer School



Qiskit Global Summer School is a two-week intensive summer program designed to empower the quantum researchers and developers of tomorrow with the know-how to explore the world of quantum computing, while also helping industry professionals refresh and sharpen their skills. This year's theme, ***A Decade on the Cloud***, celebrates how far we have come since IBM put the first quantum computer on the cloud, while also taking a forward-looking lens towards the next ten years.

Please read through this Attendee Guide to find answers about the structure, setup, agenda, and resources that accompany the summer school. This is not a passive course - active participation is key to making it a success. Grab a notebook and a pen and find your favorite chair – Qiskit Global Summer School is just about here!

We appreciate your support in keeping this experience among registered attendees only and welcome your feedback and suggestions for any improvements. Please do not share the course materials outside of Qiskit Global Summer School.

What's New This Year



Beginners-only track: We're introducing a new learning track to better support beginners with no prior Qiskit experience. Access the same learning content without the pressure of completing advanced lab assignments and programming exercises. You will be automatically sorted into the beginner track based on the self-assessment you completed during registration.

Scoring updates: This year, to qualify for Completion Certificates or Badges, participants must watch 80% of all core IBM Quantum lectures. Participants in the advanced track must also complete lab assignments. Special guest lectures and panel discussions are not graded and will not affect final scores.

QGSS Workshops: We're introducing a new series of optional professional development sessions aimed at participants entering the quantum workforce. These sessions will cover topics such as reading quantum papers, using GitHub, and networking best practices. Workshops are not graded and will not affect final scores.

Resources



Prerequisites

Minimal prerequisites are required for Qiskit Global Summer School. To follow this year's course, you will need to understand the basics of quantum computing and be familiar with Qiskit. Below are necessary resources to prepare yourself for #QGSS26.

- Visit the [Qiskit YouTube Channel](#)
 - [Introduction to Qiskit](#)
 - [How to Install Qiskit](#)
 - [Hello World](#)
 - [Primitives](#)
 - [Use a Quantum Computer Today](#)

JULY 13 Monday	JULY 14 Tuesday	JULY 15 Wednesday	JULY 16 Thursday	JULY 17 Friday
8:00 AM ET QGSS Welcome Session 8:30 AM ET Why Quantum? What Problem Are We Solving? 10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Roland de Putter 12:00 PM ET Lab 1: Building Quantum Circuits for Real Hardware	8:00 AM ET Quantum Mechanics for Computation 10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Kevin Sung 12:00 PM ET Workshop 1: Why Does Quantum Computing Seem Scary?	8:00 AM ET Programming Quantum Computers 10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Ibrahim Shehzad 12:00 PM ET Lab 2: Noise, Backends, and Benchmarking in Qiskit	8:00 AM ET Entanglement & Quantum Effects 10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Thaddeus Pellegrini 12:00 PM ET Workshop 2: How to Use GitHub	8:00 AM ET Noise, Hardware, and Reality 10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Haimeng Zhang 12:00 PM ET Distinguished Lecture with Ignacio Cirac

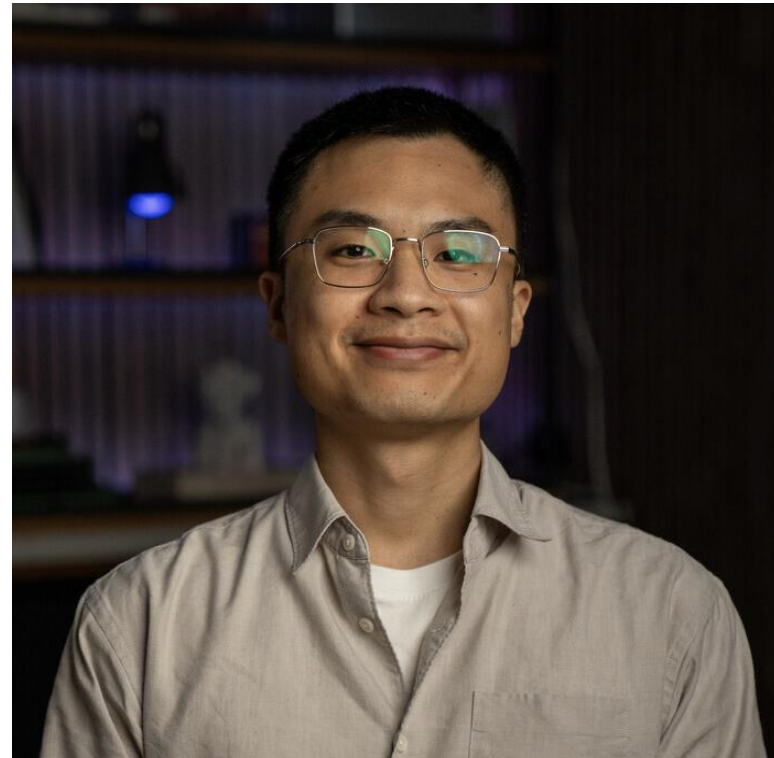
JULY 20 Monday	JULY 21 Tuesday	JULY 22 Wednesday	JULY 23 Thursday	JULY 24 Friday
8:00 AM ET Quantum + HPC: Hybrid Workflows	8:00 AM ET Quantum Algorithms I: Simulation of Physical Systems	8:00 AM ET Quantum Algorithms II: Sample-based Methods for Quantum Simulation	8:00 AM ET Quantum Algorithms IV: Optimization	8:00 AM ET Workshop 4: From Coffees to Contracts: How to Network
10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Vincent Pascuzzi	10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Will Kirby	10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Javier Robledo Moreno	10:00 AM ET Live Q&A with Sabina Dragoi	10:00 AM ET Panel Discussion & Closing Ceremony
12:00 PM ET Lab 3: Your New Tool for Quantum Advantage	12:00 PM ET Workshop 3: How to Read an Academic Paper	12:00 PM ET Quantum Algorithms III: Tracking Advantage	11:30 AM ET Distinguished Lecture with Aram Harrow	
2:00 PM ET Distinguished Lecture with Kennie Merz & Fangchun Liang		2:00 PM ET Live Q&A with Minh Tran	2:00 PM ET Lab 4: Towards Quantum Advantage	

IBM Quantum Lecturers

Our expert speakers from around the world include industry leading researchers and developers in Quantum Computing – representing the pioneering work of IBM and IBM Quantum.



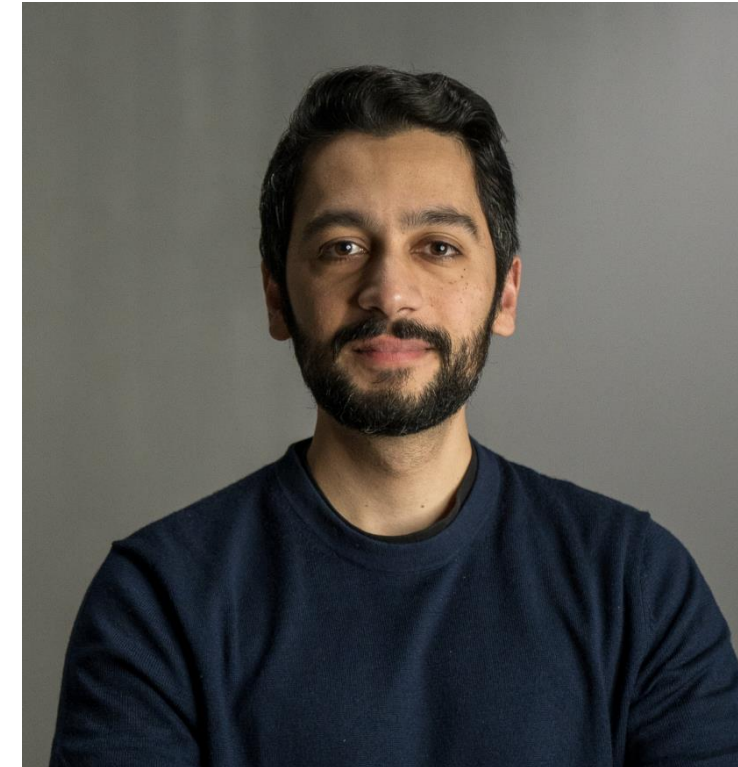
Roland de Putter



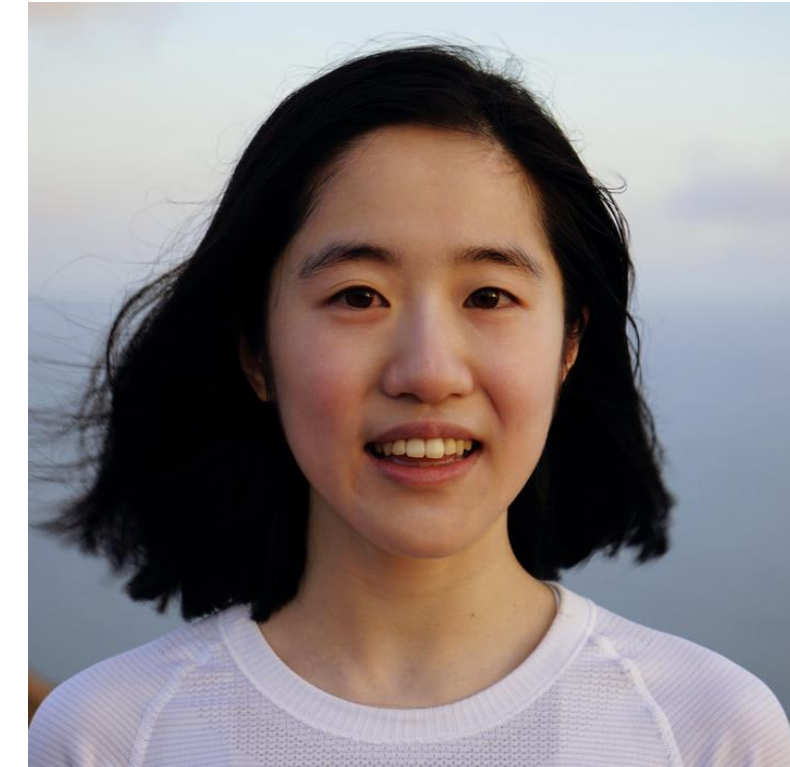
Kevin Sung



Thaddeus Pellegrini



Ibrahim Shehzad



Haimeng Zhang



Vincent Pascuzzi



Will Kirby



Javier Robledo Moreno



Minh Tran



Sabina Dragoi

IBM Quantum Lab Creators



Sophy Shin



James Weaver



Jorge Martinez



Alberto Maldonado Romo



Sophie Engineer



Boseong Kim



Gwonhak Lee



Marcel Pfaffhauser

Distinguished Speakers

This year's program will feature four distinguished speakers sharing their insights on a variety of quantum computing topics. We are so excited to welcome them to Qiskit Global Summer School!



Ignacio Cirac
Max Planck Institute
of Quantum Optics



Kenneth Merz
Cleveland Clinic



Fangchung Liang
Cleveland Clinic



Aram Harrow
MIT

Program Information



The program will include in-depth lectures, 4 graded laboratory exercises, a panel discussion and optional workshops.

With the exception of final lab submission deadlines, the program is self-paced. Students can access content and complete labs whenever it is most convenient for them during the two-week program. Sessions will all be recorded and available for live participation and post viewing.

Students should anticipate a minimum time commitment of 35 hours for the full Summer School, but we recommend planning on 45 hours of participation, allowing for additional time for discussion and collaboration with other students.

Lectures & Panels

- Live Q&As will be hosted following the lectures
- Be an active audience member - take notes!

Labs

- Lab 0 will be available on [ON24](#) beginning **July 8** to help you set up for subsequent exercises
- Labs will demonstrate lecture material with hands-on exercises on quantum programming using Qiskit

Lab Access



Labs will demonstrate lecture material with hands-on exercises on quantum programming using Qiskit, with an estimated time to complete of 2-4 hours per lab. Bonus exercises are not required for completion.

Participation and the completion of at least one lab are required to receive a **certificate of participation** from the Summer School. To achieve a passing grade and acquire a **badge of Quantum Excellence**, you must complete **ALL four core labs** and their respective exercises.

IBM Quantum Account

We will be using the [upgraded IBM Quantum Platform](#) on IBM Cloud for grading and submission of lab exercises. If you haven't yet migrated, please follow [this migration guide](#) to register an account on the new platform.

For QGSS, please create an instance using the Open Plan, which includes 10 minutes of free QPU time per month.

Note: Creating a new account currently requires a credit card for verification purposes. However, to avoid any charges while participating in QGSS, be sure to select the Open Plan, which offers limited free usage.

There is a 30-day free trial that will not require a credit card – you can register for it [here](#).



This year, we'll be using ON24 for all streamed and live content.

1. To join your event, head to the [Qiskit Global Summer School engagement hub](#). You must be registered for the event, but you also may need to login with your email address to access the sessions.
2. Once logged in, navigate to one of the desired tabs. For example:
 - Lectures
 - Lab
 - Workshops
3. Click on the lecture or lab session you would like to join.
 - If the session has already happened and is now on-demand you will have to press play to be taken to the media player.

Helpful Tips

- You can adjust what your session view looks like, expand the video player, open and close the chat, Q&A box, and speaker information as desired.
- If you receive a pop-up that asks you to register, click on the tab that says login and enter the email address you registered with.
- Use Chrome for the best viewing experience.

Discord

Discord will be used for Summer School event communications, updates, study groups, lab work, and more. **In order to gain access to the channels in the QGSS Discord, all students must click the “Verify” button in the #verification channel.** This button will confirm your status as a student in the Summer School, which will allow you to collaborate with others.

Study Groups will form and collaborate in the channels, and mentors will be able to see active groups to join to provide lab guidance and support.

[You can join the QGSS26 Discord server here](#)

Important Notice Regarding Discord Use

Discord is a third-party platform. Your use of Discord is subject to Discord’s own Terms of Service, Community Guidelines, and Privacy Policy. By joining and participating in the QGSS Discord, you acknowledge that IBM does not control, monitor, or endorse user-generated content posted on the server and is not responsible for any content, communications, or interactions that occur there. Participants are expected to conduct themselves respectfully and in accordance with applicable laws and platform rules. Any issues related to platform functionality, account access, or content moderation should be directed to Discord.



CORE

Channels

#verification

Get started here for first steps when you join the server.

#announcements

Follow this channel for all live announcements and updates.

#code-of-conduct

Review the IBM Quantum Community Code of Conduct and other guidelines - thank you for supporting an inclusive and welcoming community throughout the course!

Certificates & Badges



This year, to qualify for Completion Certificates or Badges, participants must watch 80% of all core IBM Quantum lectures. Special guest lectures, panel discussions, Q&As, and workshops are not graded and will not affect final scores. Participants in the advanced track must also complete lab assignments.

- **Certificate of Completion:** 80% of core lectures viewed
- **Quantum Fundamentals Badge:** 80% of core lectures viewed + 1-2 labs completed
- **Quantum Excellence Badge:** 80% of core lectures viewed + 3-4 labs completed

Lab work will be assigned throughout the Summer School as Jupyter notebook exercises. The notebooks must be completed and submitted following the Summer School **no later than Wednesday, July 29 (12:00 PM ET)**. You have the option to submit your notebook multiple times, but only the highest score will contribute to your cumulative average.

Do NOT share your solutions on your personal GitHub or elsewhere! This may lead to disqualification from earning a badge.

IBM Quantum Community Code of Conduct



In our collective mission to continue to promote and encourage an inclusive and welcoming global quantum community, the IBM Quantum Community Code of Conduct is available for download and review below:

[\[Code of Conduct \]](#)

You can also report anonymous Code of Conduct violations or offensive/inappropriate content by emailing quantum.events@us.ibm.com

We're here to help!

Please follow these guidelines to ensure the most timely and efficient support from the QGSS team.



Guidelines

- Read thoroughly through this Attendee Guide for answers
- Reach out in designated channel(s)
- Allow 1-2 business days for a response
- Avoid spam! If you need multiple issues addressed, please detail them in one request when possible
- Avoid direct messages or emails to QGSS team
- Avoid submitting the same request in multiple locations

Discord

#general-support

For any general support questions or support requests.

#technical-support

For any support requests regarding the IBM Quantum Platform

Email

quantum.events@us.ibm.com

For requests involving personal or sensitive information. Please note this may result in longer reply times.

FAQs

Will the sessions be recorded? Is live participation required?

Yes, all lectures, core labs, panels, and Q&As will be recorded! Live participation is encouraged but not required – you can join live or watch the content on-demand.

How many students are in Qiskit Global Summer School?

There are about 12,000 students registered for the 2026 Summer School.

Can my friend/student/colleague be added to the Summer School or Discord?

No, unfortunately the event is at capacity.

Can I download/share this content?

Not yet - the team will share all of this (and more!) as an update to the Qiskit YouTube channel later this year.

Can I use LLMs to solve lab exercises?

We don't believe this year's labs can be solved simply by asking an LLM for the answers. If you want to get the most out of your time (and out of the substantial effort the Qiskit team put into designing these labs), we encourage you to make your best effort to complete them yourself. Feel free to use LLMs as a learning aid to help you understand concepts, debug code, or point you in the right direction, but don't let them do the thinking for you. You'll get far more out of the experience if you wrestle with the problems yourself.

For more and up-to-date FAQs, particularly around technical access and the cloud migration please click [here](#).



IMPORTANT !!

Please make sure to use [Google Chrome](#) for headache-free course access.

